

John Oosthuizen, PhD

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May 2026

Professional Profile

Distinguished Musicologist, Academic Editor & AI Subject Matter Expert

A dedicated researcher and scholar with a PhD in Music, specializing in the intersection of musicological analysis, technical authoring, and academic governance. I offer high-level expertise in Academic Writing, Editing, and Proofreading, with a mastery of complex referencing frameworks (including Stellenbosch-Harvard, APA, MLA, and Chicago). Experienced in AI Subject Matter Expertise (SME), providing "human-in-the-loop" evaluation for LLMs regarding music theory, composition, and technical documentation. I bridge the gap between rigorous academic standards and modern digital workflows.

Core Expertise

- Academic Editorial: Expert-level proofreading, developmental editing, and thesis supervision. Specialized in ensuring adherence to Harvard (SU), APA, MLA, and Chicago styles.
- Music Subject Matter Expertise: Deep knowledge of Music Theory, French Romanticism, Organ Performance Practice, and South African contemporary genres.
- AI Training & Evaluation: SME for Music Theory and Technical Communication; specialist in RLHF (Reinforcement Learning from Human Feedback) and prompt engineering.
- Technical Authoring: Published author with a background in translating complex conceptual systems into accessible, high-level documentation.
- Linguistic Precision: Specialised English instruction for academic and technical purposes (EAP/ESP).

Research & Academic Experience

Academic Researcher & Lecturer | Stellenbosch University | 2018 – Present

- Thesis Supervision & Editing: Direct experience in the rigorous drafting and editing of high-level academic papers. Expert at managing the technicalities of the Stellenbosch-Harvard referencing style.
- Curriculum Design: Developed and delivered digital-first curricula for Music Theory and Aural Training, focusing on clear communication of abstract concepts.
- Scholarly Authoring: Produced three major peer-reviewed theses focusing on genre synthesis and performance practice.
- Academic Peer Review: Ongoing contributor to the evaluation and refinement of musicological research for publication.

Published Technical Author | IBM / McGraw-Hill

- High-Level Communication: Authored *AS/400 Application Development With VisualAge* (McGraw-Hill) and multiple technical Redbooks, focusing on the conceptual clarity of complex systems.
 - Documentation Architecture: Managed the bridge between high-level architectural requirements and user-facing instructional content.
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Technical Skills and Editorial Toolkit

- Reference Management: Mendeley, Zotero, EndNote, and manual mastery of Harvard/Stellenbosch-Harvard conventions.
 - Editorial Tools: MS Word (Advanced Track Changes/Styles), Google Docs/Sheets (distributed team collaboration), Overleaf (LaTeX), Adobe Acrobat Pro.
 - Music Technology: Sibelius, Finale, MuseScore, Digital Audio Workstations (DAWs).
 - Remote Workflow: Slack, Microsoft Teams, Zoom, Asana, Trello.
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Strategic Governance and Digital Strategy

Senior Consultant & Enterprise Architect | 2007 – 2017

- Conceptual Architecture: Provided high-level strategic oversight for global entities including Sanlam and IBM.
- Technical Governance: Led digital strategy and framework development, ensuring alignment between organizational goals and technical execution.
- Global Collaboration: Managed stakeholder relations and technical roadmaps across diverse international regions (Singapore, MN, South Africa).

Education and Certifications

- PhD in Music: Stellenbosch University (2025)
- MMus (Organ Performance Practice): Stellenbosch University (2022)
- BSc Mathematics & Computer Science: University of KwaZulu-Natal
- Mini-MBA: Harvard Business School (2010)
- Trinity College London: ATCL Piano and Grade 8 Organ (2019)
- Professional Certifications: TOGAF 8 (Conceptual Systems Architecture)